TIPS & TRICKS

Autofetch the last argument

So often, we copy the last command's argument and paste it for the next command. We do this task manually by selecting the argument, and then copying and pasting it.

Here is a time-saving tip that I'm sure you will love. Check the following example:

```
mkdir /home/cg/root/maulik
```

The *mkdir* command is to create a new directory. The next task is to go inside this directory. Most people will copy the path, write the *cd* command and then paste it.

Here is another simpler approach. Use '!$', which will fetch the last argument automatically. The other option is to use the 'Esc + .' command after *cd*.

> **Note:** '!$' or 'Esc + .' will fetch the last argument for any command. If the last command has no argument, then these will fetch the last command.

```
bash-4.3$
bash-4.3$ pwd
/home/cg/root
bash-4.3$
bash-4.3$
bash-4.3$ mkdir /home/cg/root/maulik
bash-4.3$ cd !$
cd /home/cg/root/maulik
bash-4.3$ pwd
/home/cg/root/maulik
```

—Maulik Parekh. maulikparekh2@gmail.com

Retain the remote terminal using the screen

If we happen to close the remote terminal session, we can still run the task on the remote terminal without an issue by using the 'screen' tool.

We need to have *screen* installed on the remote Linux machine so that we can use it.

```
$apt-get install screen
```

Start a screen session on the remote machine, as follows:

```
$screen -S name
```

After a disconnect to the remote Linux machine, run the following command to get back to the same screen terminal that was being used:

```
$screen -dr name
```

Here, 'name' is the screen session's name. To know the list of the active screen sessions, use the following command:

```
$screen -list
```

—Vasanthakumar T, vasanth_22k@rediffmail.com

Using the long list command without *ls -l*

You can use the undocumented long list or the *ll* (double l) command as follows. If appended with the directory names, it will produce a long list of the following:

1. All the items present in appended directories.
2. The hidden files as well.
3. The space occupied by directories.
4. The directories in sequence, ranging from those with the least files to those with the most files.

On many distros, this won't work, in which case, you can create an alias *ll* of *ls –l*.

—Tejas Rawal, tejasprawal@gmail.com

Disk space usage by 'n' number of items in a file

To find out the disk usage by 'n' number of items in a